

20 USEFUL PHRASES TO TALK ABOUT DAILY ROUTINES

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About the Author



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He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

Talking about daily routines is a very common topic in IELTS Speaking.

In this PDF, I will show you

- 1. How to talk about daily routines**
- 2. Some phrases for morning routines**
- 3. How to link your ideas**



1. HOW TO TALK ABOUT DAILY ROUTINES

There are many ways to express routines, which basically are activities that you do on a regular basis.

Let's begin with an example of **'I get up early'**

If this is something you **usually** do, but not always, you can say,

- *I **usually** get up early*
- *I **will** get up early (meaning a habit you have)*
- *I **tend to** get up early*
- *I **typically** get up early*

If this is something you **always** do, you can say,

- I **always** get up early
- I **religiously** get up early
- I **invariably** get up early

You can see above we have used adverbs, but we can also use adverbial phrases (adverbs of 2 or more words).

Note, these usually go at the beginning or end of a sentence.

The following are adverbial phrases for routines we sometimes do.

Now and again

- *I get up at 10 o'clock **now and again***

Now and then

- *I get up at 10 o'clock **now and then***

From time to time

- ***From time to time**, I get up at 10 o'clock*

The following are adverbial phrases for routines we always do.

Without fail

- *I get up at 6 o'clock **without fail***

Day in, day out

- *I get up at 6 o'clock **day in, day out***

2. PHRASES FOR MORNING ROUTINES

To **sleep in** = to deliberately stay in bed longer than usual

- *I typically **sleep in** until 11am on Saturday mornings*

To **oversleep** = to stay in bed longer than usual, by mistake

- *I try to never **oversleep**!*

To **have breakfast**

- *I invariably **have** breakfast at home with my family*

Note, we only add 'a' if we use an adjective here.

- *I tend to have **a** big breakfast*
- *Now and again, I have **a** full English breakfast*

To **grab** _____ = to take something quickly

- *I **grab** a coffee*
- *I **grab** a cup of tea*
- *I **grab** a quick breakfast*

To **head off to** = to go to a place

- *I **head off** to work*
- *I **head off** to school*
- *I **head off** to the gym*

To **sort out** = to get ready / prepared

- *My wife typically **sorts** the kids **out** for school*
- *I will **sort out** the kids for school, if I have time*

I do the _____

- *I **do the** cooking*
- *I **do the** cleaning*
- *I **do the** washing (washing clothes)*
- *I **do the** pots/dishes (washing the dishes, plates...)*
- *I **do** some yoga*

If you go to the gym, the following can also be used,

- *I **go down** the gym*
- *I **hit** the gym*

3. HOW TO LINK YOUR IDEAS

It is important in IELTS Speaking to use connectors so your speech sounds coherent and more fluent.

The good news is, in spoken English we tend to use very simple connectors, especially when talking about a series of activities or routines.

So, there is no need to overcomplicate this, just use some simple connectors like the ones below.

I _____
and then _____
After that _____
Next _____
and then later _____

For example,

- *I get up at 7am*
- **and then** *I have breakfast*
- **After that**, *I have a shower*
- **Next**, *I get dressed*
- **and then later**, *I go to work*

You can make this more complex, not by changing connectors, but by using some of the adverbial phrases and phrases for routines above.

- *I sleep in at the weekend,*
- *but on a weekday I invariably get up early,*
- **and then** *I have a shower*
- **After that**, *I get myself some breakfast, brush my teeth,*
- **and then later**, *head off to work*

Grammar Point

When a verb follows a preposition it needs to be in the gerund form (ending in ING).

Preposition + Verb + ING

After	having	a shower
Before	going	to work

So, you can say either of the two below.

- *After I have a shower, I get dressed*
- *After having a shower, I get dressed*

Model Answer

Do you have a regular morning routine?

*Now and then, I sleep in at the weekend,
but on a weekday I invariably get up early,
and then have a shower.*

*After that, I get myself some breakfast, brush my teeth,
and then later, head off to work*

*Typically on Tuesdays, I hit the gym before going to work
I like to keep in shape.*



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